

Spirited effort: The world number 25 defeated three top-10 players at the Asian Badminton Championships, before faltering in the final against China's Shi Yuqi. GETTY IMAGES

« I believe I can be the best in the world »

AYUSH SHETTY

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Ayush Shetty's remarkable run to the final at the Asian Badminton Championships came with an unexpected trade-off. With the rest of the Indian contingent exiting much earlier, the 20-year-old was still in action on the last day, thereby finding himself stranded in Ningbo without a return flight to India.

The extra day in China gave him time to reflect on a week in which the world number 25 defeated three top-10 players. He began by beating China's world number 7 Li Shifeng in the opening round, then got the better of former Asian Games champion and world number 4 Jonatan Christie in the quarterfinals, before overcoming world number 1 and Paris Olympics silver medallist Kunlavut Vitidsarn in the semifinals.

